

3.34. ELEMENTARY TRANSFORMATIONS (OR OPERATIONS)

Any one of the following operations on a matrix is called an elementary transformation (or E-operation).

(i) **Interchange of two rows or two columns.**

The interchange of i th and j th rows is denoted by R_{ij} .

The interchange of i th and j th columns is denoted by C_{ij} .

(ii) **Multiplication of (each element of) a row or column by a non-zero number k .**

The multiplication of i th row by k is denoted by kR_i .

The multiplication of i th column by k is denoted by kC_i .

(iii) **Addition of k times the elements of a row (or column) to the corresponding elements of another row (or column), $k \neq 0$.**

The addition of k times the j th row to the i th row is denoted by $R_i + kR_j$.

The addition of k times the j th column to the i th column is denoted by $C_i + kC_j$.

If a matrix B is obtained from a matrix A by one or more E-operations, then B is said to be **equivalent** to A .

Two equivalent matrices A and B are written as $A \sim B$.

3.35. ELEMENTARY MATRICES

The matrix obtained from a unit matrix I by subjecting it to one of the E-operations is called an elementary matrix.

For example, let $I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$

(i) Operating R_{23} or C_{23} on I , we get the same elementary matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$.

It is denoted by E_{23} . Thus, the E-matrix obtained by either of the operations R_{ij} or C_{ij} on I is denoted by E_{ij} .

(ii) Operating $5R_2$ or $5C_2$ on I , we get the same elementary matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 5 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

It is denoted by $5E_2$. Thus, the E-matrix obtained by either of the operations kR_i or kC_i is denoted by kE_i .

(iii) Operating $R_2 + 4R_3$ on I , we get the elementary matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

It is denoted by $E_{23}(4)$. Thus, the E-matrix obtained by the operation $R_i + kR_j$ is denoted by $E_{ij}(k)$.

(iv) Operating $C_2 + 4C_3$ on I , we get the elementary matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, which is the

transpose of $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = E_{23}(4)$ and is therefore, denoted by $E'_{23}(4)$. Thus, the E-matrix obtained by the operation $C_i + kC_j$ is denoted by $E'_{ij}(k)$.

3.36. THE FOLLOWING THEOREMS ON THE EFFECT OF E-OPERATIONS ON MATRICES HOLD GOOD

(a) Any E-row operation on the product of two matrices is equivalent to the same E-row operation on the pre-factor.

If the E-row operation is denoted by R , then $R(AB) = R(A) \cdot B$.

(b) Any E-column operation on the product of two matrices is equivalent to the same E-column operation on the post-factor.

If the E-column operation is denoted by C , then $C(AB) = A \cdot C(B)$.

(c) Every E-row operation on a matrix is equivalent to pre-multiplication by the corresponding E-matrix.

Thus, the effect of E-row operation R_{ij} on $A = E_{ij} \cdot A$

The effect of E-row operation kR_i on $A = kE_i \cdot A$

The effect of E-row operation $R_i + kR_j$ on $A = E_{ij}(k) \cdot A$

(d) Every E-column operation on a matrix is equivalent to post-multiplication by the corresponding E-matrix.

Thus, the effect of E-column operation C_{ij} on $A = A \cdot E_{ij}$

The effect of E-column operation kC_i on $A = A \cdot (kE_i)$

The effect of E-column operation $C_i + kC_j$ on $A = A \cdot E'_{ij}(k)$.

3.37. INVERSE OF MATRIX BY E-OPERATIONS (GAUSS-JORDAN METHOD)

The elementary row transformations which reduce a square matrix A to the unit matrix, when applied to the unit matrix, give the inverse matrix A^{-1} .

Let A be a non-singular square matrix. Then $A = IA$

Apply suitable E-row operations to A on the left hand side so that A is reduced to I .

Simultaneously, apply the same E-row operations to the pre-factor I on right hand side.

Let I reduce to B , so that $I = BA$

Post-multiplying by A^{-1} , we get

$$IA^{-1} = BAA^{-1} \Rightarrow A^{-1} = B(AA^{-1}) = BI = B$$

$$B = A^{-1}.$$

Note. In practice, to find the inverse of A by E-row operations, we write A and I side by side and the same operations are performed on both. As soon as A is reduced to I , I will reduce to A^{-1} .

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLES

Example 1. Find the inverse of $A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ by elementary row operations.

Sol. Writing the given matrix side by side with unit matrix I_3 , we get

$$[A : I_3] = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 2 & : & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 & : & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 & : & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating R_{12}

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & : & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & : & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 & : & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_3 - 3R_1$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & : & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & : & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -5 & -8 & : & 0 & -3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_1 - 2R_2, R_3 + 5R_2$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 & : & -2 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & : & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & : & 5 & -3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $\frac{1}{2} R_3$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 & : & -2 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & : & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & : & \frac{5}{2} & -\frac{3}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_1 + R_3, R_2 - 2R_3$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & : & \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & : & -4 & \frac{3}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & : & \frac{5}{2} & -\frac{3}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix} = [I_3 : A^{-1}]$$

$$A^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \\ -4 & \frac{3}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{5}{2} & -\frac{3}{2} & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix}$$

3.38. RANK OF A MATRIX

Let A be any $m \times n$ matrix. It has square sub-matrices of different orders. The determinants of these square sub-matrices are called minors of A . If all minors of order $(r+1)$ are zero but there is at least one non-zero minor of order r , then r is called the rank of A . Symbolically, rank of $A = r$ is written as $\rho(A) = r$.

From the definition of the rank of a matrix A , it follows that :

- (i) If A is a null matrix, then $\rho(A) = 0$.
[$\because$ every minor of A has zero value.]
- (ii) If A is not a null matrix, then $\rho(A) \geq 1$.
- (iii) If A is a non-singular $n \times n$ matrix, then $\rho(A) = n$
[$\because |A| \neq 0$ is the largest minor of A .]

If I_n is the $n \times n$ unit matrix, then $|I_n| = 1 \neq 0 \Rightarrow \rho(I_n) = n$.

- (iv) If A is an $m \times n$ matrix, then $\rho(A) \leq \text{minimum of } m \text{ and } n$.
- (v) If all minors of order r are equal to zero, then $\rho(A) < r$.

To determine the rank of a matrix A , we adopt the following different methods :

- (i) Start with the highest order minor (or minors) of A . Let their order be r . If any one of them is non-zero, then $\rho(A) = r$.

If all of them are zero, start with minors of next lower order $(r-1)$ and so on till you get a non-zero minor. The order of that minor is the rank of A .

This method usually involves a lot of computational work since we have to evaluate several determinants.

- (ii) If A is an $m \times n$ matrix and by a series of elementary (row or column or both) operations, it can be put into one of the following forms (called normal forms) :

$$\begin{bmatrix} I_r & : & O \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ O & : & O \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} I_r \\ \vdots \\ O \end{bmatrix}, [I_r \quad : \quad O], [I_r], \text{ where } I_r \text{ is the unit matrix of order } r.$$

Since the rank of a matrix is not changed as a result of elementary transformations, it follows that

$$\rho(A) = r.$$

$$[\because r\text{th order minor } |I_r| = 1 \neq 0]$$

Note. For an $m \times n$ matrix A , to find square matrices P and Q of orders m and n respectively, such that PAQ is in the normal form $\begin{bmatrix} I_r & O \\ O & O \end{bmatrix}$.

Method. Write $A = IAI$.

Reduce the matrix on L.H.S. to normal form by affecting elementary row and/or column transformations.

Every elementary row transformation on A must be accompanied by the same transformation on the pre-factor on R.H.S.

Every elementary column transformation on A must be accompanied by the same transformation on the post-factor on R.H.S.

Example 2. Find the rank of the matrix

$$(i) \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ -2 & 0 & 5 & 7 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$(ii) \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 4 & 2 \\ 2 & 6 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$(iii) \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 & 4 & -1 \\ 5 & 2 & 0 & -1 \\ -4 & 5 & 12 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$(iv) \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 0 \\ 2 & 4 & 3 & 2 \\ 3 & 2 & 1 & 3 \\ 6 & 8 & 7 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$(v) \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 & -1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 & -2 & -4 \\ 3 & 1 & 3 & -2 \\ 6 & 3 & 0 & -7 \end{bmatrix}$$

Sol. (i) Here $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ -2 & 0 & 5 & 7 \end{bmatrix}$ is a 2×4 matrix.

$\therefore \rho(A) \leq 2$, the smaller of 2 and 4.

The second order minor $\begin{vmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ -2 & 0 \end{vmatrix} = 4 \neq 0 \quad \therefore \rho(A) = 2$.

(ii) Here $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 4 & 2 \\ 2 & 6 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$ is a 3×3 matrix. $\therefore \rho(A) \leq 3$

Operating $R_2 - R_1, R_3 - 2R_1$

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ Operating } R_3 - R_2$$

$$= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

The only third order minor is zero, but the second order minor

$$\begin{vmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 2 \end{vmatrix} = 2 \neq 0 \quad \therefore \rho(A) = 2.$$

(iii) Here $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 & 4 & -1 \\ 5 & 2 & 0 & -1 \\ -4 & 5 & 12 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$ is a 3×4 matrix.

$\therefore$

$$\rho(A) \leq 3$$

Operating C_{14}

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 3 & 4 & 2 \\ -1 & 2 & 0 & 5 \\ -1 & 5 & 12 & -4 \end{bmatrix} \text{ Operating } R_2 - R_1, R_3 - R_1$$

$$= \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 3 & 4 & 2 \\ 0 & -1 & -4 & 3 \\ 0 & 2 & 8 & -6 \end{bmatrix} \text{ Operating } R_1 + 3R_2, R_3 + 2R_2$$

$$= \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 & -8 & 11 \\ 0 & -1 & -4 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

All the third order minors are zero but the second order minor

$$= \begin{vmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{vmatrix} = 1 \neq 0 \quad \therefore \rho(A) = 2.$$

(iv) Here $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 0 \\ 2 & 4 & 3 & 2 \\ 3 & 2 & 1 & 3 \\ 6 & 8 & 7 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$ is a 4×4 matrix.

$$\therefore \rho(A) \leq 4$$

Operating $R_4 - (R_3 + R_2 + R_1)$

$$A \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 0 \\ 2 & 4 & 3 & 2 \\ 3 & 2 & 1 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_2 - 2R_1, R_3 - 3R_1$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 & 2 \\ 0 & -4 & -8 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating R_{23}

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 0 \\ 0 & -4 & -8 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

The only fourth order minor is zero. Since the third order minor

$$\begin{vmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & -4 & -8 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 \end{vmatrix} = (1)(-4)(-3) = 12 \neq 0 \quad \therefore \rho(A) = 3$$

(v) Here $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 & -1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 & -2 & -4 \\ 3 & 1 & 3 & -2 \\ 6 & 3 & 0 & -7 \end{bmatrix}$ is a 4×4 matrix. $\therefore \rho(A) \leq 4$

Operating R_{12}

$$A \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -2 & -4 \\ 2 & 3 & -1 & -1 \\ 3 & 1 & 3 & -2 \\ 6 & 3 & 0 & -7 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $C_2 + C_1, C_3 + 2C_1, C_4 + 4C_1$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 5 & 3 & 7 \\ 3 & 4 & 9 & 10 \\ 6 & 9 & 12 & 17 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_2 - 2R_1, R_3 - 3R_1, R_4 - 6R_1$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 5 & 3 & 7 \\ 0 & 4 & 9 & 10 \\ 0 & 9 & 12 & 17 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_2 - R_3, R_4 - 2R_3$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -6 & -3 \\ 0 & 4 & 9 & 10 \\ 0 & 1 & -6 & -3 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{Operating } C_3 + 6C_2, C_4 + 3C_2$$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 33 & 22 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{Operating } R_3 - 4R_2, R_4 - R_2$$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 33 & 22 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{Operating } \frac{1}{33} C_3$$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 22 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{Operating } C_4 - 22C_3$$

$$\sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & : & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & : & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & : & 0 \\ \dots & \dots & \dots & \dots & \dots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & : & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} I_3 & : & O_{3 \times 1} \\ \dots & \dots & \dots \\ O_{1 \times 3} & : & O_{1 \times 1} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\therefore \rho(A) = 3.$$

Example 3. For the matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$, find non-singular matrices P and Q such that PAQ is in the normal form.

Sol. We write $A = IAI$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 0 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} A \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $C_2 - C_1, C_3 - 2C_1$ (subjecting the *post-factor* on R.H.S. to same operations)

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} A \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_2 - R_1$ (subjecting the *pre-factor* on R.H.S. to same operation)

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} A \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $C_3 - C_2$ (subjecting the *post-factor* on R.H.S. to same operation)

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} A \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Operating $R_3 + R_2$ (subjecting the *pre-factor* on R.H.S. to same operation)

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} A \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\Rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} I_2 & O_{2 \times 1} \\ O_{1 \times 2} & O_{1 \times 1} \end{bmatrix} = PAQ \text{ where } P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ and } Q = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

TEST YOUR KNOWLEDGE

1. Reduce to triangular form $\begin{bmatrix} 3 & -4 & -5 \\ -9 & 1 & 4 \\ -5 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

2. Use Gauss Jordan method to find the inverse of the following matrices :

(i) $\begin{bmatrix} 8 & 4 & -3 \\ 2 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$

(ii) $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 & -1 \\ 5 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$

(iii) $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 \\ 5 & 2 & -3 \end{bmatrix}$.

3. Find the rank of the matrices

(i) $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 3 & 1 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$

(ii) $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 2 & 4 & 7 \\ 3 & 6 & 10 \end{bmatrix}$

(iii) $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 1 & 2 & 6 & 7 \\ 1 & 5 & 0 & 10 \end{bmatrix}$.

4. Determine the rank of the matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} 6 & 1 & 3 & 8 \\ 4 & 2 & 6 & -1 \\ 10 & 3 & 9 & 7 \\ 16 & 4 & 12 & 15 \end{bmatrix}$ by reducing it to the normal form.

5. Find the rank of

(i) $\begin{bmatrix} 3 & -1 & 2 \\ -6 & 2 & 4 \\ -3 & 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$

(ii) $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 2 \\ 2 & 3 & 5 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 & 4 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$

(iii) $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & 2 & -3 \\ 4 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 3 & 1 & 4 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$

(iv) $\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & -3 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 & -2 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$.

6. Find non-singular matrices P and Q such that PAQ is in the normal form for the matrix

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Answers

2. (i) $\frac{1}{21} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 10 & -7 \\ 1 & -11 & 14 \\ -3 & 12 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$

(ii) $\begin{bmatrix} 3 & -1 & 1 \\ -15 & 6 & -5 \\ 5 & -2 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$

(iii) $\begin{bmatrix} 8 & -1 & -3 \\ -5 & 1 & 1 \\ 10 & -1 & -4 \end{bmatrix}$.